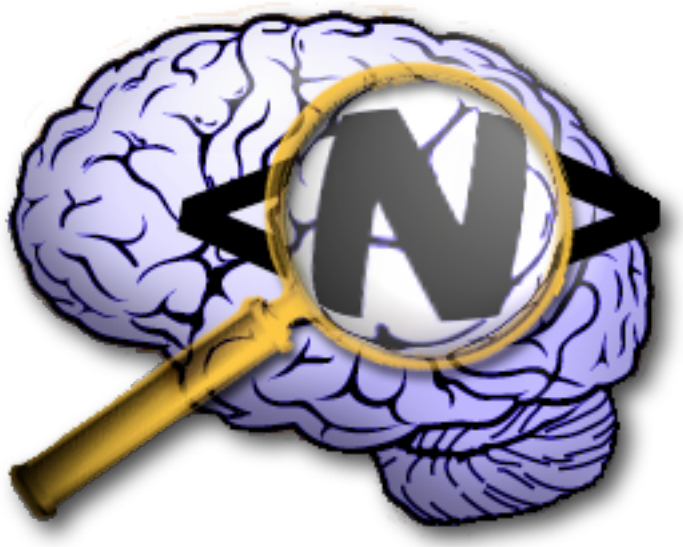
BrainMapper

<NEURON> Database Management Software



User Manual
Version 1.0
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Denis Goekdag

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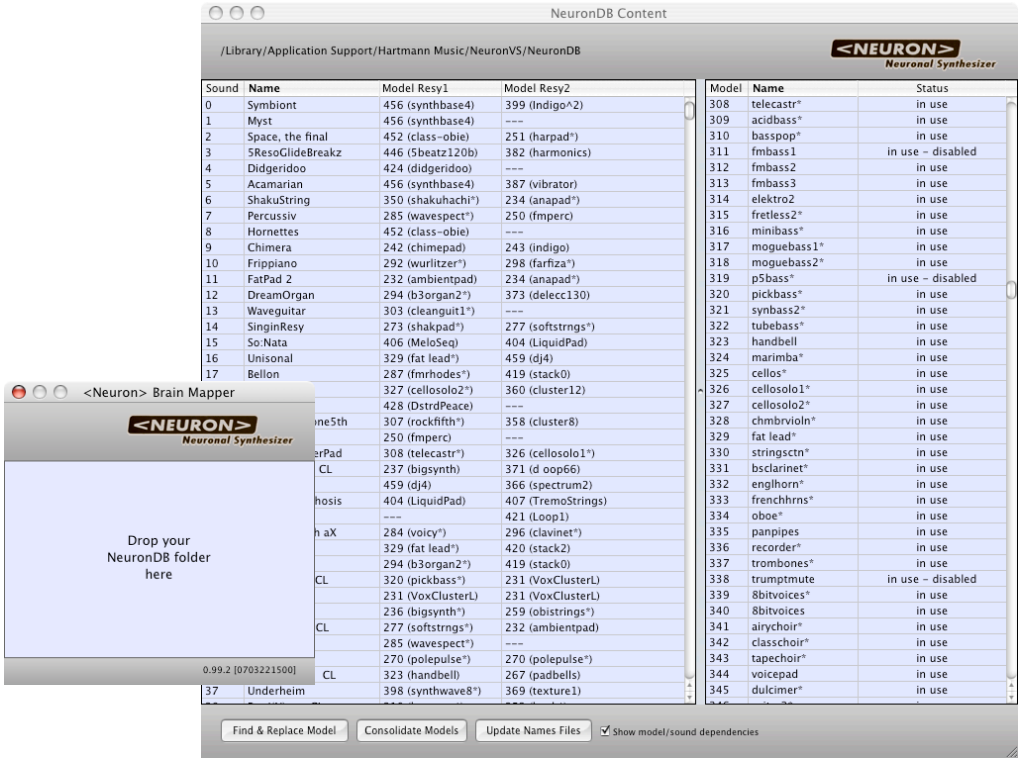
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Welcome!

Congratulations and thank you for downloading this novel OSXTools software for your Hartmann Music <Neuron> or <NeuronVS> synthesizer.



BrainMapper: Getting Stuff Organised.

The **<Neuron> Brain Mapper** is a database editing utility for the Hartmann Music <Neuron> and <Neuron> VS synthesizers. It is a freeware application for Mac OS X.

The <Neuron> and <Neuron> VS synthesizers share the same synthesis architecture: a *Sound* (or "Patch") contains two *Resynators* (aka "Re-Synthesis Oscillators"), each of

which plays back a *Model* (which can be thought of as a "Waveform" combined with a "Synthesis Algorithm"). As both the *Sounds* and the *Models* are referenced by Slot-Numbers, a *Sound* does not contain the names of the two *Models* used, but their numbers. This results in a lot of possible problems when working with these synths:

- There are only 512 Model slots. Once they are used up, the only option is to back up some Models and overwrite them with new ones...which breaks all Sounds using these Models without any means to tell which Sounds are/would be affected ("oh man, i just broke the main lead sound 'cause i didn't realise it used that crap model i just over-wrote....")

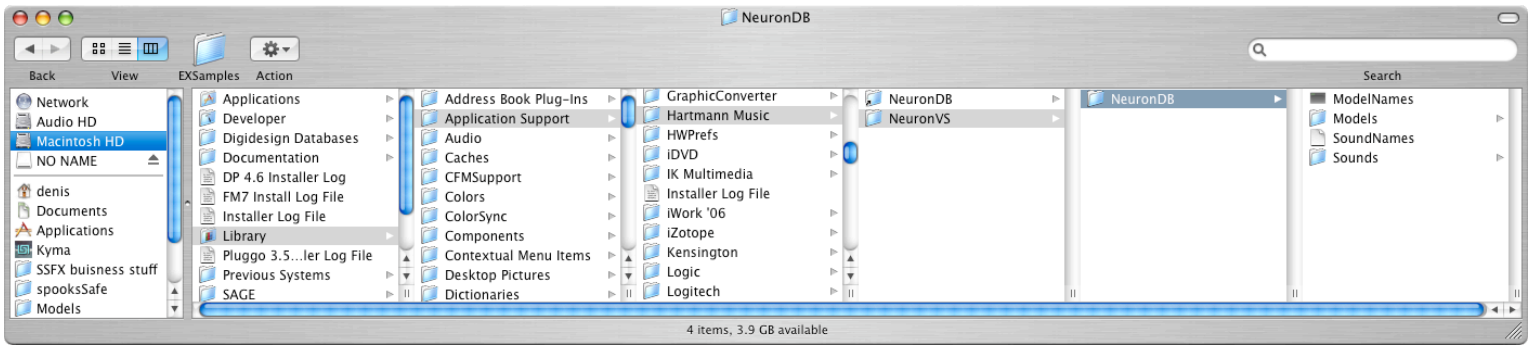
- Re-Ordering, Sorting and any other procedure that moves Models around to other slots are extremely tedious (re-naming xxx.model folders) and potentially break a lot of Sounds (unless you manually load every single Sound, write down the names of the Models used, then, after moving Models around, load every single Sound again, load the two Models used from their new locations and save.....hooray, now that's the really fun part of sound-design isn't it?)

BrainMapper solves these issues..... It allows you to move Models to other memory locations without breaking the Sounds they are used in, and allows you to easily identify and remove unused Models, freeing up space for new stuff. It also allows you to see which Sound uses which Models without having to load each Sound one by one, and to replace a Model in all Sounds with a different one. Last but not least, it will write the „soundnames“ and „modelnames“ files required by the Neuron VS to display the correct names in the plugin's menus. All in all, this set of features should save the serious <Neuron> User a significant amount of time.

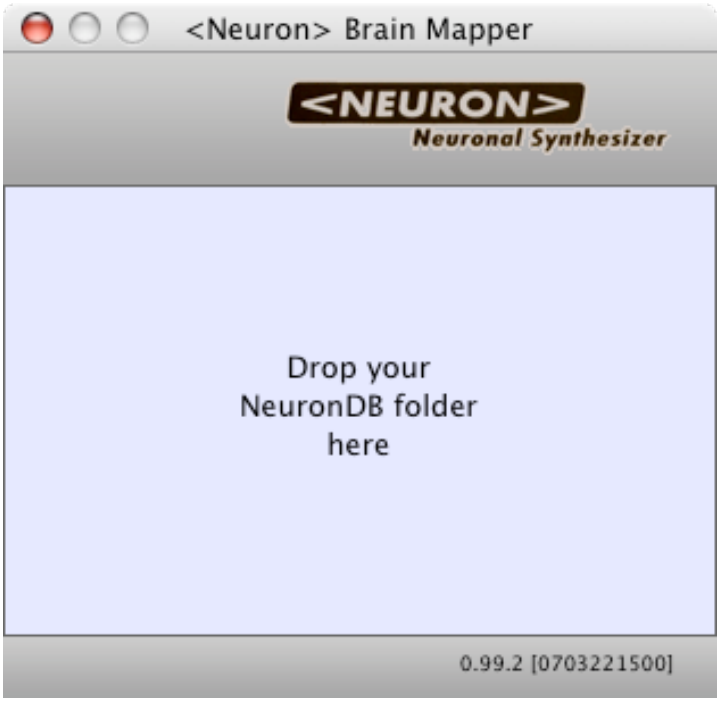
How does it work?

There is no "Undo" in BrainMapper, all changes are final. Make a backup copy of your Neuron database befor doing any editing.

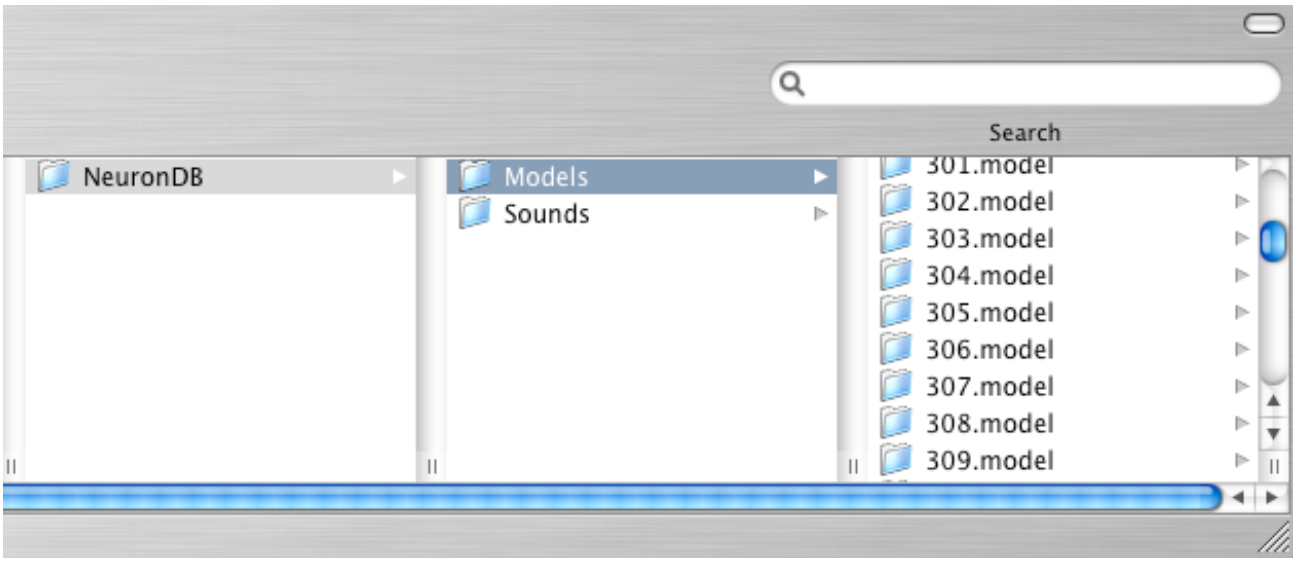
To be able to do what it does, **BrainMapper** creates a database by scanning your Sounds and Models. You then edit this database, and **BrainMapper** translates these changes back into the Sounds- and Model-Folders for you. Users of the <Neuron> VS simplay drag their "NeuronDB" folder, which is located at Macintosh HD/Library/Application Support/ Hartmann Music/NeuronVS:



to the **BrainMapper** application Icon or the **BrainMapper** Analyser Window:



For users of a <Neuron> Keyboard, the process is slightly more involved. First you need to create a folder on your HD. This folder can be called whatever you like, but calling it "NeuronDB" or similar isn't a bad idea. For this manual we'll assume you call it "NeuronDB". Next, copy all Sounds and Models from your Neuron to this folder using an FTP client, making sure that all Sounds are placed into a sub-folder called "Sounds" and all Models into a sub-folder called "Models". For details on how to do this consult your <Neuron> user guide. Your folder should now look something like this:



From here, the process is the same as for the VS: simply drag the "NeuronDB" folder to the **BrainMapper** application icon or the analyser window. **BrainMapper** will now analyse your Sounds and Models. After editing the contents of your database, you will need to upload all Sounds and Models back to your <Neuron> keyboard before changes take effect. <Neuron> VS users need to do nothing special to "finalize" their editing.

Once the analysis process has finished, **BrainMapper** will display the main application window, which will look something like this:

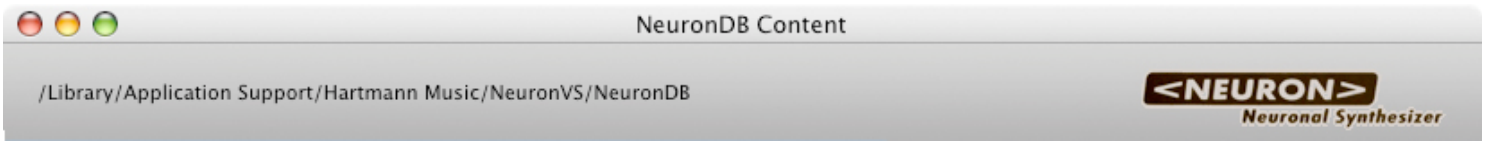


Sound	Name	Model Resy1	Model Resy2
0	Symbiont	456 (synthbase4)	399 (Indigo^2)
1	Myst	456 (synthbase4)	---
2	Space, the final	452 (class-obie)	251 (harpad*)
3	5ResoGlideBreakz	446 (5beatz120b)	382 (harmonics)
4	Didgeridoo	424 (didgeridoo)	---
5	Acamarian	456 (synthbase4)	387 (vibrator)
6	ShakuString	350 (shakuhachi*)	234 (anapad*)
7	Percussiv	285 (wavespect*)	250 (fmperc)
8	Hornettes	452 (class-obie)	---
9	Chimera	242 (chimepad)	243 (indigo)
10	Frippiano	292 (wurlitzer*)	298 (farfiza*)
11	FatPad 2	232 (ambientpad)	234 (anapad*)
12	DreamOrgan	294 (b3organ2*)	373 (delecc130)
13	Waveguitar	303 (cleanguit1*)	---
14	SinginResy	273 (shakpad*)	277 (softstrngs*)
15	So:Nata	406 (MeloSeq)	404 (LiquidPad)
16	Unisonal	329 (fat lead*)	459 (dj4)
17	Bellon	287 (fmrhodes*)	419 (stack0)
18	Cellohold	327 (cellosolo2*)	360 (cluster12)
19	Mass+Time	428 (DstrdPeace)	---
20	MyBloodyDrone5th	307 (rockfifth*)	358 (cluster8)
21	Woodpegger	250 (fmperc)	---
22	JohnCarpenterPad	308 (telecastr*)	326 (cellosolo1*)
23	Bad News CL	237 (bigsynth)	371 (d oop66)
24	Albion	459 (dj4)	366 (spectrum2)
25	Chronomorphosis	404 (LiquidPad)	407 (TremoStrings)
26	TechLoop	---	421 (Loop1)
27	Sarah's Laugh aX	284 (voicy*)	296 (clavinet*)
28	Neurologue	329 (fat lead*)	420 (stack2)
29	Netobjects	294 (b3organ2*)	419 (stack0)
30	Curry Up ! CL	320 (pickbass*)	231 (VoxClusterL)
31	Detuned	231 (VoxClusterL)	231 (VoxClusterL)
32	5th	236 (bigsynth*)	259 (obistrings*)
33	Sting String CL	277 (softstrngs*)	232 (ambientpad)
34	Waver	285 (wavespect*)	---
35	Vangelista	270 (polepulse*)	270 (polepulse*)
36	Foggy Dew CL	323 (handbell)	267 (padbells)
37	Underheim	398 (synthwave8*)	369 (texture1)

Model	Name	Status
308	telecastr*	in use
309	acidbass*	in use
310	basspop*	in use
311	fmbass1	in use - disabled
312	fmbass2	in use
313	fmbass3	in use
314	elektro2	in use
315	fretless2*	in use
316	minibass*	in use
317	moguebass1*	in use
318	moguebass2*	in use
319	p5bass*	in use - disabled
320	pickbass*	in use
321	synbass2*	in use
322	tubebass*	in use
323	handbell	in use
324	marimba*	in use
325	cellos*	in use
326	cellosolo1*	in use
327	cellosolo2*	in use
328	chmbrvioln*	in use
329	fat lead*	in use
330	stringsctn*	in use
331	bsclarinet*	in use
332	englhorn*	in use
333	frenchhrns*	in use
334	oboe*	in use
335	panpipes	in use
336	recorder*	in use
337	trombones*	in use
338	trumptmute	in use - disabled
339	8bitvoices*	in use
340	8bitvoices	in use
341	airychoir*	in use
342	classchoir*	in use
343	tapechoir*	in use
344	voicepad	in use
345	dulcimer*	in use

This window is basically divided into four sections: the database path display, the Sound list, the Models list and the function button area. We'll now briefly describe each section.

The database path display.



This area simply displays the path to the <Neuron> database that you have analysed and are currently editing. It helps you discern which database you are working on if you have multiple databases on HD. That's it, no frills.

The Sound List.

Sound	Name	Model Resy1	Model Resy2
0	Symbiont	456 (synthbase4)	399 (Indigo^2)
1	Myst	456 (synthbase4)	---
2	Space, the final	452 (class-obie)	251 (harpad*)
3	5ResoGlideBreakz	446 (5beatz120b)	382 (harmonics)
4	Didgeridoo	424 (didgeridoo)	---
5	Acamarian	456 (synthbase4)	387 (vibrator)
6	ShakuString	350 (shakuhachi*)	234 (anapad*)
7	Percussiv	285 (wavespect*)	250 (fmperc)
8	Hornettes	452 (class-obie)	---
9	Chimera	242 (chimepad)	243 (indigo)
10	Frippiano	292 (wurlitzer*)	298 (farfiza*)
11	FatPad 2	232 (ambientpad)	234 (anapad*)
12	DreamOrgan	294 (b3organ2*)	373 (delecc130)
13	Waveguitar	303 (cleanguit1*)	---
14	SinginResy	273 (shakpad*)	277 (softstrngs*)
15	So:Nata	406 (MeloSeq)	404 (LiquidPad)
16	Unisonal	329 (fat lead*)	459 (dj4)
17	Bellon	287 (fmrhodes*)	419 (stack0)
18	Cellohold	327 (cellosolo2*)	360 (cluster12)
19	Mass+Time	428 (DstrdPeace)	---
20	MyBloodyDrone5th	307 (rockfifth*)	358 (cluster8)
21	Woodpegger	250 (fmperc)	---
22	JohnCarpenterPad	308 (telecastr*)	326 (cellosolo1*)

The Sound List displays all Sounds that **BrainMapper** found in your NeuronDB, sorted by number, and the Models used by a Sound. Selecting entries works just like in the Finder: a click on a Sound will select that Sound, shift+click will add all Sounds between the selected one and the one clicked on to the selection, and apple-click adds/removes single Sounds to/from the selection.

From within the Sound List, you can perform the following actions:

- Move a Sound or a selection of multiple Sounds to a different slot by dragging the selection to the new location. This will leave empty slots at the original position, and move all Sounds following the insert position down the List. For example we could select Sounds 343 and 345:

341	SpaceDock	241 (chimepad*)	---
342	Indigo	243 (indigo)	243 (indigo)
343	WelcomeHome	241 (chimepad*)	243 (indigo)
344	Scary Bell	416 (ohhchoir*)	245 (fmbell1*)
345	Muddy Pad	240 (bloob*)	---
346	BangPad	235 (anapad)	367 (spectrum4)
347	Stephan's Pad2	232 (ambientpad)	234 (anapad*)
348	Distorture	250 (fmperc)	---
349	WarpedPad	243 (indigo)	268 (pantarei*)
350	Alfred's Voice	416 (ohhchoir*)	---
351	--<empty>--	---	---
352	--<empty>--	---	---
353	--<empty>--	---	---
354	--<empty>--	---	---

and then drag & drop them between Sounds 349 and 350, which would result in the List looking like this:

341	SpaceDock	241 (chimepad*)	---
342	Indigo	243 (indigo)	243 (indigo)
343	--<empty>--	---	---
344	Scary Bell	416 (ohhchoir*)	245 (fmbell1*)
345	--<empty>--	---	---
346	BangPad	235 (anapad)	367 (spectrum4)
347	Stephan's Pad2	232 (ambientpad)	234 (anapad*)
348	Distorture	250 (fmperc)	---
349	WarpedPad	243 (indigo)	268 (pantarei*)
350	WelcomeHome	241 (chimepad*)	243 (indigo)
351	Muddy Pad	240 (bloob*)	---
352	Alfred's Voice	416 (ohhchoir*)	---
353	--<empty>--	---	---
354	--<empty>--	---	---

Note that the two Sounds we moved used to have 1 line of "space" between them, and that they are now continous.

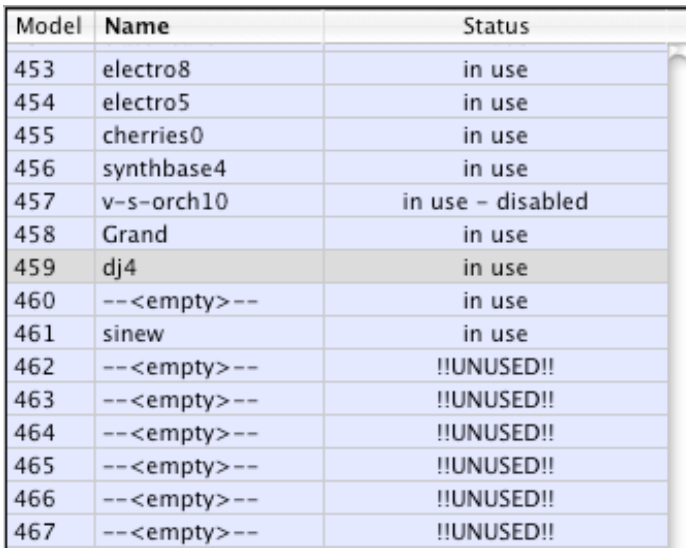
- Copy a Sound or a selection by pressing alt while dragging a Sound or a selection to a new location. Behaviour is identical to the "move" operation with regard to how following Sounds are moved; the copied Sounds will also be continous.

- Delete/Remove a Sound or multiple Sounds by right-clicking (or control-clicking) on a Sound or a selection and selecting "Delete/remove selected Sounds" from the menu that

pops up. This brings up a dialog window that allows you to cancel the operation, choose to delete the selection or to remove the selection. "Delete" will leave empty slots, "Remove" will move all following Sounds up to close the gap. Note that it is also possible to delete empty slots (where "Delete" will do nothing and "Remove" will move all following Sounds up).

- Show the Sound file in the Finder by double clicking on a Sound.

The Model List.



Model	Name	Status
453	electro8	in use
454	electro5	in use
455	cherries0	in use
456	synthbase4	in use
457	v-s-orch10	in use - disabled
458	Grand	in use
459	dj4	in use
460	--<empty>--	in use
461	sinew	in use
462	--<empty>--	!!UNUSED!!
463	--<empty>--	!!UNUSED!!
464	--<empty>--	!!UNUSED!!
465	--<empty>--	!!UNUSED!!
466	--<empty>--	!!UNUSED!!
467	--<empty>--	!!UNUSED!!

The Model List lives to the right of the Sound List. It displays all Models that **BrainMapper** found in your database, and shows one of three possible statuses for each Model:

- "In Use" : as you'd expect, this means that the Model in question is being used by one or more Sounds. Deleting a Model flagged "In Use" will break any Sound that uses it.

- "In Use - Disabled" : the Model in question is used in a Sound, but the Resynator that has this Model loaded is disabled. Deleting a Model with this flag will not break the Sound(s) using it, but taking a closer look at the Sound is probably a good idea.

- "!!UNUSED!!" : designates a Model that is not referenced by any Sound and that can thus be deleted without affecting any Sound in any way.

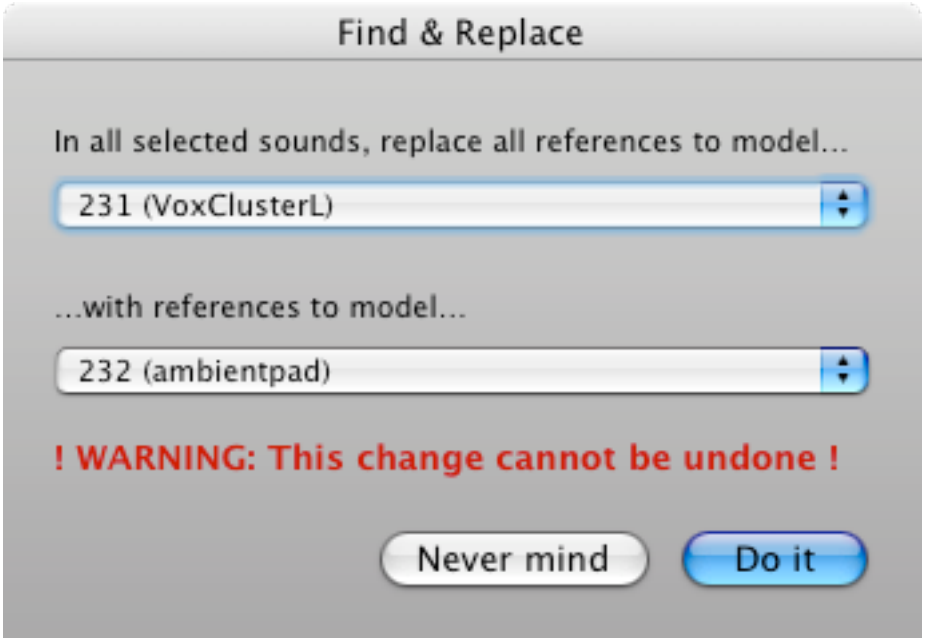
From within the Model List, you can perform the same actions on the Models that you can perform on the Sounds from within the Sound List, so we will not cover these functions again.

The Function Buttons.



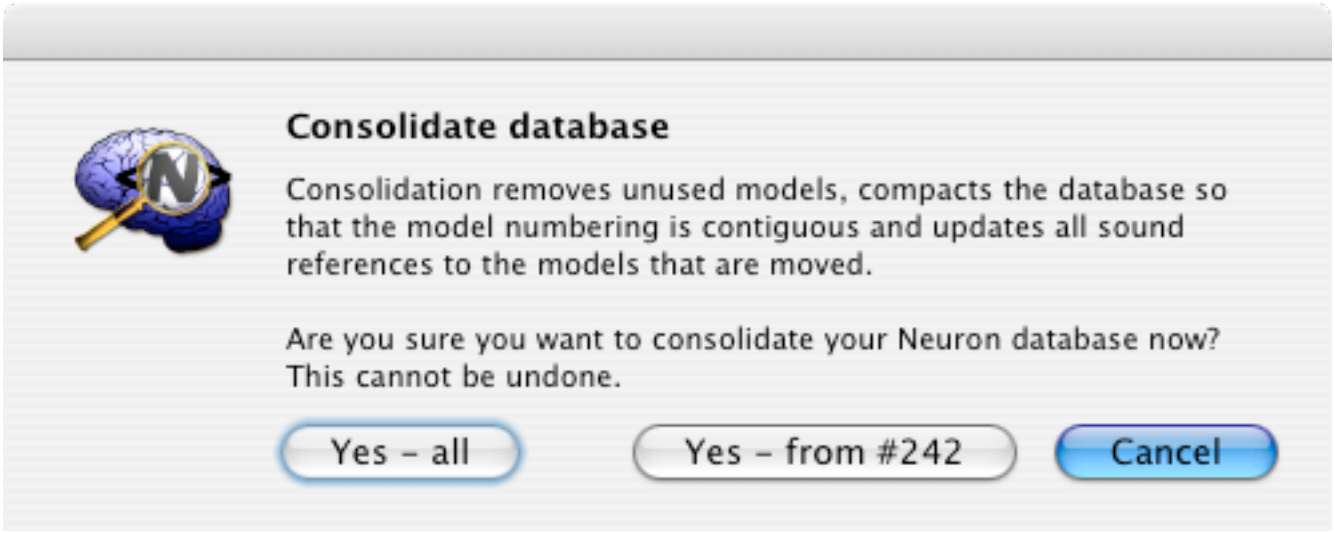
At the bottom of the main application window you will find three function buttons and one toggle switch. These allow for some more high-level operations to be performed on your database.

- Find & Replace Model : this function allows you to change all references to a particular Model in all selected Sounds to reference a different Model. In the dialog window that opens when clicking this button, you could, for example, select the following values:



This would result in all selected Sounds that use Model #231 being changed to use Model #232 instead. Imagine you have the Model of a vocal recording, and you've created a bunch of Sounds where that Model is morphed with other Models and tweaked all over the place. Now you'd like to exchange the vocal Model for a different Model without overwriting the original Model or editing all Sounds manually....voila, "Find & Replace" just made your day ;-)

- Consolidate Models : clicking this function button opens a nice window that describes it pretty well:



(In case you're wondering where the "#242" is coming from: the middle button will get that number from whatever Model you have selected, in case of multiple Models being selected it grabs the lowest selected Model number).

To put it in other words: if you press "Consolidate Models" and then "Yes - all", **BrainMapper** will remove all unused Models and move all remaining Models up to close the gaps...while updating the Sounds to still point to the correct Models. If you choose "Yes-from #xxx" it will leave all Models (and empty slots) with a lower Model-number untouched.

This function is useful for quickly "cleaning up" your database.

- Update Names Files : this function will update the "Modelnames" and "Soundnames" files found in the NeuronDB folder. This is necessary for the <Neuron> VS to display the names of Sounds and Models correctly. If the files are not present, they will be created. <Neuron> keyboard users can safely ignore this button as the <Neuron> will internally generate these files on its own.

- Show Model/Sound dependencies : with this toggle enabled, **BrainMapper** will highlight the Models a Sound uses when a Sound is selected, and will highlight the Sounds that use a Model when it is selected. There is no reason to ever switch this off.

How To import SSFX NE-Series Libraries

The **SSFX NE-Series** Libraries are programmed to use specific slots for their Models and Sounds. This means that untill now the user had to manually move whatever he already had in these slots to a new location...or overwrite it. A tedious process and unfortunate situation. **BrainMapper** makes importing a **NE-Series** library a whole lot easier. There are basically two ways of importing a library to your database:

1) Moving all your Sounds and Models out of the way to make room for the Library, and

2) Re-numbering all Sounds and Models in the library to be imported to fit them into your database.

In both cases you will need a sufficient number of free slots, 100 for the Sounds and 100 for the Models.

We'll now describe these two processes, using the **SSFX NE-01 TWILIGHT** as example. **TWILIGHT** uses Model- and Sound-slots 000 to 099.



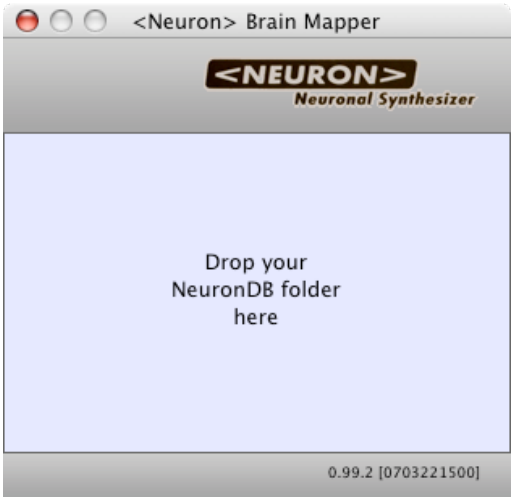
There is no "Undo" in BrainMapper, all changes are final. Make a backup copy of your Neuron database befor doing any editing.

Tutorial 1: Moving all your Stuff Around

This method is used to make room for the **TWILIGHT** content with it's original state,and is usually the fastest.

- Neuron Keyboard users please copy your Sounds and Models from your Neuron to a folder on your desktop, as described here. Neuron VS users please locate your "NeuronDB" folder. At this point you should make a backup copy of your DB.

- Start the **BrainMapper** application and drop your NeuronDB folder on the appropriate window:



- Once the **BrainMapper** has finished analysing your NeuronDB, it will display your Sounds and Models in the main application window:



Sound	Name	Model Resy1	Model Resy2
0	Symbiont	456 (synthbase4)	399 (Indigo^2)
1	Myst	456 (synthbase4)	---
2	Space, the final	452 (class-obie)	251 (harpad*)
3	5ResoGlideBreakz	446 (5beatz120b)	382 (harmonics)
4	Didgeridoo	424 (didgeridoo)	---
5	Acamarian	456 (synthbase4)	387 (vibrator)
6	ShakuString	350 (shakuhachi*)	234 (anapad*)
7	Percussiv	285 (wavespect*)	250 (fmperc)
8	Hornettes	452 (class-obie)	---
9	Chimera	242 (chimepad)	243 (indigo)
10	Frippiano	292 (wurlitzer*)	298 (farfiza*)
11	FatPad 2	232 (ambientpad)	234 (anapad*)
12	DreamOrgan	294 (b3organ2*)	373 (delecc130)
13	Waveguitar	303 (cleanguit1*)	---
14	SinginResy	273 (shakpad*)	277 (softstrngs*)
15	So:Nata	406 (MeloSeq)	404 (LiquidPad)
16	Unisonal	329 (fat lead*)	459 (dj4)
17	Bellon	287 (fmrhodes*)	419 (stack0)
18	Cellohold	327 (cellosolo2*)	360 (cluster12)
19	Mass+Time	428 (DstrdPeace)	---
20	MyBloodyDrone5th	307 (rockfifth*)	358 (cluster8)
21	Woodpegger	250 (fmperc)	---
22	JohnCarpenterPad	308 (telecastr*)	326 (cellosolo1*)
23	Bad News CL	237 (bigsynth)	371 (d oop66)
24	Albion	459 (dj4)	366 (spectrum2)
25	Chronomorphosis	404 (LiquidPad)	407 (TremoStrings)
26	TechLoop	---	421 (Loop1)
27	Sarah's Laugh aX	284 (voicy*)	296 (clavinet*)
28	Neurologue	329 (fat lead*)	420 (stack2)
29	Netobjects	294 (b3organ2*)	419 (stack0)
30	Curry Up ! CL	320 (pickbass*)	231 (VoxClusterL)
31	Detuned	231 (VoxClusterL)	231 (VoxClusterL)
32	5th	236 (bigsynth*)	259 (obistrings*)
33	Sting String CL	277 (softstrngs*)	232 (ambientpad)
34	Waver	285 (wavespect*)	---
35	Vangelista	270 (polepulse*)	270 (polepulse*)
36	Foggy Dew CL	323 (handbell)	267 (padbells)
37	Underheim	398 (synthwave8*)	369 (texture1)

Model	Name	Status
308	telecastr*	in use
309	acidbass*	in use
310	basspop*	in use
311	fmbass1	in use - disabled
312	fmbass2	in use
313	fmbass3	in use
314	elektro2	in use
315	fretless2*	in use
316	minibass*	in use
317	moguebass1^	in use
318	moguebass2^	in use
319	p5bass*	in use - disabled
320	pickbass*	in use
321	synbass2*	in use
322	tubebass*	in use
323	handbell	in use
324	marimba*	in use
325	cellos*	in use
326	cellosolo1*	in use
327	cellosolo2*	in use
328	chmbrvioln*	in use
329	fat lead*	in use
330	stringsctn*	in use
331	bsclarinet*	in use
332	englhorn*	in use
333	frenchhrns*	in use
334	oboe*	in use
335	panpipes	in use
336	recorder*	in use
337	trombones*	in use
338	trumptmute	in use - disabled
339	8bitvoices*	in use
340	8bitvoices	in use
341	airychoir*	in use
342	classchoir*	in use
343	tapechoir*	in use
344	voicepad	in use
345	dulcimer*	in use

- If you want to get rid of all Models that are not used by any Sound at this point, click the "Consolidtae Models" button. This removes all unused Models and compacts their numbering, and possibly generates enough free slots for **TWILIGHT** should space be an issue.

- If you have 100 continous free Model slots somewhere above slot #099, select the Models 000 to 099 in the Model list, and drag them to the first of the 100 empty slots. This will move these Models to their new location and update all Sounds to reflect this change.

- If you have 100 slots available, but they are not continous, you should drag single Models or smaller batches of Models from the 000-099 range to new locations above 099. This will also update the Sounds pointing to those Models, so no need to worry about breaking anything.

- Once you've made the Model slots 000-099 available, do the same with the Sounds:

- Select all your Sounds and drag them to a new location with a slot number higher than 099.

- You have now made room for the **TWILIGHT** Sounds and Models.

- Neuron Keyboard users should now upload the modified Sounds and Models back to their Neuron via FTP; this is described in the Neuron manual. Once this process has finished, you can install **TWILIGHT** as described in the **TWILIGHT** documentation...and are finished afterwards.

- Neuron VS users need to create Soundnames and Modelnames files that contain both the old and the **TWILIGHT** Sounds/Models. To to this, first quit the **BrainMapper** application.

- Copy the contents of the **TWILIGHT** library to your NeuronDB folder (Sound and Models need to go into their respective folders). It is safe to overwrite when asked by the operating system (provided you have performed all steps in this tutorial correctly...if not you'll be happy that you made a BACKUP ;-))

- Start the **BrainMapper** application, drop the NeuronDB onto the appropriate window.

- The main application window should now show all your Sounds and Models, including the **TWILIGHT** content.

- Click on the "Update Names Files" button.

- Done :-)

Tutorial 2: Re-numbering TWILIGHT content.

This method leaves all your data in-place and modifies the TWILIGHT content to "fit inbetween". Depending on which slots are already in use and how large the continous blocks of free slots are, this may take a while. Also note that any additional Sounds delivered by Surround SFX that make use of library content will not point to the correct Models if you use this procedure, so in general we recommend method 1.

- Decide on which slots you want to use for the **TWILIGHT** Sounds and Models. To make this easier it may be a good idea to first move around the Sounds and Models in your NeuronDB to make as much continous space available as possible. Ideally you would free up 100 continous slots for both the Models and Sounds. We'll assume that you end up with one continous block of free slots (both for Models and Sounds) for this tutorial. How to do this is described in Tutorial 1. Neuron Keyboard users: don't forget to upload the modifed content back to your Neuron before continuing!

- Make note of the positions you want **TWILIGHT** content to start, for example Sounds #444-543 and Models #400-499.

- Create a folder on your desktop and label it "NeuronDB_NE01" or similar and copy the "Sounds" and "Models" folders from the **TWILIGHT** DVD into it.

- Start the **BrainMapper** application and drop the NeuronDB_NE01 folder on the appropriate window.

- This brings up the main application window.

- Select all Models and drag them to the desired starting slot number (#400 in this example).

- Once **BrainMapper** has finished processing, select all Sounds and drag them to their new location (#444 and following in this example)

- Neuron Keyboard users can now simply upload the modified contents of the NeuronDB_NE01 folder to the Neuron via FTP (as described in the Neuron manual and the **TWILIGHT** manual) and are finished.

- Neuron VS users should now copy the contents of the NeuronDB_NE01 folder to the NeuronDB folder (Sound and Models need to go into their respective folders). It is safe to overwrite when asked by the operating system (provided you have performed all steps in this tutorial correctly...if not you'll be happy that you made a BACKUP ;-))

- Quit and re-launch the **BrainMapper** application, and drop the NeuronDB folder onto the appropriate window.

- The main application window should now show all your Sounds and Models, including the **TWILIGHT** content.

- Click on the "Update Names Files" button.

- Done.

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